

PATIENT SAFETY GUIDELINES

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SYNTHETIC DEMONSTRATION DOCUMENT. Written for the CareFlow AI portfolio project; fictional guidance.

1. Patient Identification

Use at least two patient identifiers (full name plus date of birth or medical record number) before giving medicines, taking samples, performing procedures or sharing information. Room or bed number is never an identifier.

2. Falls Prevention

Complete a falls risk assessment within 24 hours of admission using the Morse Fall Scale and repeat it after any fall, transfer or change in condition. A Morse score of 45 or higher indicates high risk. High-risk patients receive a low bed, non-slip footwear, a call bell within reach, hourly rounding and a review of sedating medicines.

3. Pressure Injury Prevention

Assess pressure injury risk with the Braden Scale within 8 hours of admission. A Braden score of 18 or less indicates risk; reposition at-risk patients at least every 2 hours and use pressure-redistributing mattresses.

4. Hand Hygiene

Perform hand hygiene at the five moments: before touching a patient, before a clean or aseptic procedure, after body fluid exposure risk, after touching a patient, and after touching patient surroundings.

5. Clinical Handover

Use the SBAR structure (Situation, Background, Assessment, Recommendation) for every shift and inter-department handover. Include allergies, high-alert medications, pending results and escalation plans.

6. Recognising Deterioration

Staff must call the rapid response team when a patient has a NEWS2 of 7 or more, a new drop in consciousness, a respiratory rate above 30 per minute, systolic blood pressure below 90 mmHg, or when staff are worried about the patient even if the score is low.

7. Incident Reporting

Report every incident, near miss and unsafe condition in the incident reporting system within 24 hours. Serious incidents are escalated to the patient safety lead immediately. The hospital operates a just culture: reporting is encouraged and not punitive.

8. Speaking Up

Every staff member is expected to stop an unsafe action. The phrase "I need you to stop, this is a safety concern" must be respected by all colleagues regardless of seniority.

9. Privacy

Access patient information only when it is needed for that patient's care. All access to electronic records is audited.